

Hazrat Musa and Hazrat Haroon

(Alaihimus Salām)

Bani Israel in Egypt

During the story on Nabi Yusuf ﷺ mention was made of Bani Israel. When Nabi Yaqoob ﷺ and his sons met Yusuf ﷺ after many years, the whole family i.e., the children of Israel moved from Canaan and came to settle in Egypt. Now after a few centuries in the discussion on the history of Nabi Musa ﷺ the Qur'ān again tells the story of Bani Israel in considerable detail.

From the details in the Torah, Nabi Yusuf ﷺ applied to the King of Egypt to grant the land of Jaeshaan (Goshen) to his father and the family. This request was granted with great pleasure. These details show that during the time from Nabi Yusuf ﷺ to Nabi Musa ﷺ. Bani Israel remained settled in Egypt. Their numbers increased to about 600,000

(According to the national Geographic Magazine of January 1976 they were 600 families in just under 15000 persons).

Fir'own

Fir'own is the name given to the Kings of Egypt. It is not the name of any specific King. According to history it is said that from 3000 years B.C. upto the era of Alexander the Great 21 dynasties ruled over Egypt. The name of the ruler over Egypt during Nabi Musa (*Alaihis Salām*)'s era cannot be given with complete certainty. For that reason the ruler of that era is known as Fir'own.

Fir'own's Dream

According to the Torah and historians, Firown's enmity towards Bani Israel started as a result of fortune-tellers and astrologers informing him that his government was going to come to an end as a result of an Israeli young boy.

According to another report Fir'own saw a dreadful dream and the fortune -tellers and astrologers informed him that the meaning was that his rule would come to an end as a result of an Israeli boy. There upon he formed a group of men to investigate and search for all new-born Israeli boys to kill them, leaving the girls to live.

Birth of Musa ﷺ

The lineage of Nabi Musa ﷺ is connected to Hazrat Yaqoob ؑ with a few generations between them. His father's name was Imraan and his mother was Yukabad. Musa ؑ was born in the house of Imraan at such a time when firown had already passed a decree that all Israeli new born boys were to be killed. For about three months the birth was kept a secret so that no one outside came to know of it.

At such a delicate and dangerous time Allah's help and He cast into the mother's heart that she should make a coffin-

like box to be polished ever with grease to prevent water from entering into it. She was inspired to place the child in it and to put the box on the river Nile.

She did as she was inspired to do and ordered her daughter to keep the box in view, walking along the bank of the Nile as it flowed along. Allah had promised He would bring him back to her, and make him a Messenger of His.

Brought up in the House of Fir'own

The sister followed the box, walking along the bank of the Nile. Finally she saw the box stopping in the reeds in front of the palace of Fir'own. One of the women from the household of Fir'own had the box picked up from the water and taken to the palace. The sister became very pleased and in order to find out details of what transpired she joined and mixed with the servants.

The mother was impatiently waiting for news of her child when the daughter came to tell her the full story, saying:

"You must now come and look after your child
thank Allah for having been true to His
promise."

In this manner Allah made an arrangement for the rearing of Musa ﷺ.

Musa (Alaihis Salām)'s Exit from Egypt

For quite a period Musa ﷺ grew up and was reared in the royal palace until he entered the stage of his youth and finally became strong in body. He became a man inspiring awe in others with a special kind of dignity about him. He had come to that he was actually an Israeli with no blood relationship with the Egyptians.

He noticed the great injustices under which Bani Israel was suffering and how they were treated so that they lived a life of humiliation, like slaves. Seeing all this affected him badly and on various occasions he exerted himself for the help and protection of the Israelites.

Once he was walking somewhere on the outskirts of town. He saw an Egyptian fighting with an Israelite with the aim of forcing the Israelite to do some work. The Israelite saw Musa عليه السلام and asked him for help. Musa عليه السلام became angry at the injustice of the Egyptian. He tried to get Egyptian to stop, but he would not heed. He went nearer, became angry and struck the Egyptian one blow. The Egyptian immediately fell down dead. This filled Nabi Musa عليه السلام with sorrow and regret. It was not his aim to kill the man. In his heart he immediately fell down dead. This filled Nabi Musa عليه السلام he immediately expressed his regret and remorse, saying:

"This is the doing of *Shaitan*. He is the one who pats man on the wrong path."

He prayed to Allah:

"O Allah all that happened was done unintentionally I seek your pardon and forgiveness."

Allah immediately forgave his fault. The news of the killing of the Egyptian became spread all over, but nobody knew the killer. Later they laid a charge with Fir'own, saying that the killing must have been the work of an Israelite. They demanded that the killer be found and brought to justice. Fir'own replied he could not take revenge against the whole Israelite nation but promised that if the murderer was brought to him, he would act.

The next day it so happened that Musa ﷺ was again walking on the outskirts of the town when he saw the same Israelite involved in a fight with another Egyptian. The Egyptian had the upper hand over the Israelite. Again he saw Musa ﷺ and again he asked for help.

Seeing this Nabi Musa ﷺ became doubly displeased. On the one side was the injustice of the Egyptian and on the other side the Israelite's making such a noise. At the same time he remembered the previous day's happening. He stretched forth his hand to stop the Egyptian while at the same time scolding the Israelite:

"You are truly it is clear, a quarrelsome fellow."

When the Israeli saw the hand stretched in his direction and heard the voice with displeasure in it, he thought Nabi Musa ﷺ was about to attack him, he uttered in a fearful voice:

"O Musa ﷺ, do you wish to kill me as you killed a man yesterday?"

The Egyptian broke loose and ran off to tell the whole story to the authorities and to inform Fir'own that the killer of the Egyptian was Musa ﷺ. Fir'own gave instructions to the jailor to arrest Musa ﷺ immediately. Among those present when this instruction was given was one who had great love for Musa ﷺ. This man left there and came running Musa ﷺ before he could be arrested and told him of his impending arrest. He advised Musa ﷺ to save himself by fleeing from Egypt to where they will not be able to lay hands on him. Nabi Musa ﷺ accepted his advice and quietly slipped out of Egypt in the direction of Mad'yan (Midian).

Musa (Alaihis Salām)'s Hijrat towards Madyan

In the discussion on Nabi Shuaib عليه السلام we dealt with the land of *Madyan*. This land is situated about eight manzils from Egypt. Nabi Musa عليه السلام fled from Egypt due to fear for Fir'own. This fleeing was very sudden and therefore there was none to accompany him without away provisions for the road and he was in fact bare-footed. In this imprepared state Musa عليه السلام entered the land of *Madyan*.

The Waters of Madyan

On entering Madyan he saw a well with a watering place where people were crowding to water their animals. He also saw two young girls standing on one side with their sheep and goats, waiting, but being prevented from coming to the water.

Nabi Musa عليه السلام saw this and inquired from them: "why do you not water your animal? why do you stand here?"

They replied:

"We are forced to wait. If we move forward with our animals these stronger men force us back. Our father is very old and he is unable to ward off this problem. So when these people are finished watering their animals, then only can we water our animals and return. This is what happens here every day."

Hearing this made Musa عليه السلام quite angry. He stepped forward and went in among the crowd, pushing them aside. He then took the big bucket and pulled water by himself and gave their animals to drink. The people who were standing there was greatly displeased at this incident but seeing the powerful figure and strength of Musa عليه السلام, they were over-awed into silence.

When the girl's animals had drunk they returned home. Their father was surprised at their early return and the girls told him the whole story of how a man had helped them. The father then ordered them to go and bring the man to him.

At that time Nabi Musa ﷺ after watering the animals sat down in the shade of a tree, an exile on travel, being hungry and without any refuge.

He lifted up his hands in prayer:

"O Lord, I am in need of any good that you send me."
(28:24)

When the one girl came there she found him sitting under the tree. She said to him shyly: "My father calls you. He wants to reward you for your goodness."

Nabi Musa ﷺ rose up and took the road to the house of her father as directed by her. Soon he reached there. First they gave him to eat and then listened to his story. Musa ﷺ told the story of his birth and related all the injustices of Fir'own. Then the old man said:

"Praise be to Allah. You have now been saved from the claws of the unjust people. Do not fear."

(The Qur'ān called the old man a "*Shaikh Kabeer*").

Marriage to the Daughter of the Shaikh

The girl who came to call Musa ﷺ said to her father:

"O father engage him on wages, as a herdsman and to give the animals water to drink. The best of men to employ is he who is strong and trust worthy."
(28:26)

When the father heard this suggestion, he was pleased. And said to Musa ﷺ:

"If you are to remain with me in service for eight years, herding my sheep, I will give you my daughter in marriage. If you are going to stay two more years later, completing ten years it will be the *Mahr*.

Nabi Musa ﷺ accepted the condition and asked that it be left at his discretion.

That he may decide which of the two periods to complete.

After the completion of the period the old man married Musa ﷺ to his daughter.

(Maulana Seoharwy has clarified that the old man whom the Qur'ān calls the *Shaikh Kabeer* was not Nabi Shuaib ﷺ because this period was several centuries after the time of Nabi Shuahib ﷺ).

The Sacred Valley

After the marriage Nabi Musa ﷺ stayed with his father-in-law until the end of the agreed period. The *Mufasssireen* mention that Musa completed the full period.

After the marriage Nabi Musa ﷺ and his new family continued to look after the sheep of his father-in-law and during the grazing period he managed to move quite a distance away from Madyan. This was not unusual for flock-herding. The night was quite cold and he was in search of some fire by which they could warm themselves. Ahead of him Mount Sina: came into view. This was the western side of the Sinai peninsula, one day journey from *Madyan* at

near where the Red Sea forms two spots of water around the peninsula on the road leading to Egypt.

Musa عليه السلام used flintstone to try and light a fire but due to the excessive cold he could not light a fire. As he looked ahead of him towards the '*Waadee Ayman*'

he saw Fire burning in distance. He told his wife to remain where they were: "I shall go and bring fire for us to warm ourselves and if at the fire I should find some guide, he could show us the way after we had lost the way."

The Qur'ān puts it this way:

"Musa عليه السلام said to his wife: Tarry you here. I see a fire.

Perhaps I can bring you some burning brand there from or find some guidance at the fire."

(20:10)

Musa عليه السلام as Messenger

It is Allah's great favour that Musa عليه السلام went to fetch fire and there he found prophet hood and became a Messenger.

Musa عليه السلام saw something wonderful about the fire. Light was shining upon a bush but the fire did neither burn the trees nor was the fire extinguished. Seeing this he went nearer, but the nearer he came the further the fire went away.

Musa عليه السلام started feeling fear in himself and wanted to return from there. As he was about to return, the fire came nearer and he heard a voice saying to him: "O Musa عليه السلام, I am Allah, creator of the Universe. (28:30)

"When Musa عليه السلام came near to the fire it was called out, O Musa عليه السلام, I am your Lord. Take

off your shoes, You are standing in the sacred valley of Tuwa and behold, I have chosen you to be my Messenger. So listen to what is revealed to you." (20: 11—13)

When Musa عليه السلام heard this voice from Allah's side and he realized that at that moment he was favoured with great spiritual wealth which is the highest rank of superiority to which any human could reach and also realized that this was Allah's final sign of love towards him. He was astonished and remained silent until the voice again started, asking him:

"What is that in your right hand?"

Musa عليه السلام replied: "It is my staff, on which I lean and with which during my flock-herding, I cut off grass and leaves for the sheep.

Then Allah said: "Throw it down, O Musa!"

Musa عليه السلام did as he was ordered:

"Musa عليه السلام threw it down and behold! It was a snake active in motion. (20:20)

Seeing this Musa عليه السلام was astonished and according to human nature began to flee from there. But once again the voice spoke:

"Seize it in your hand and fear not. We shall at once return it to its former state." (20:21)

The staff had two branches. Now the two branches appeared as the mouth of the serpent snake. Musa عليه السلام was worried but the nearness of Allah caused calmness to descend upon him. Thus without fear he stretched his hand at the hear of the snake and as he touched it the snake became

transformed into a stick. Now the next command came to Musa ﷺ to put his hand against his side and to put the hand into his bosom and it will come out while without any sickness. He did this and so it became white, shining. Then he was ordered to do so once more and the hand returned to its former natural state.

Then Allah informed him:

"O Musa ﷺ, these are to you two signs of your Prophethood and Messengership. This is your assistance in the conveying the Message. Just as we had blessed you with Prophethood and Messengership so also we grant you these two miracles (*Moujizaat*)."

"These are two credentials from your Lord to Fir'own and his chiefs. For truly they are people rebellious and wicked." (28:32)

"Now go and show Fir'own and his people the path of guidance.

He has done much rebellious things and disobedience and he has in his arrogance and pride performed many injustices.

He has made Bani Israel into slaves. So proceed and deliver them from slavery."

Nabi Musa ﷺ replied: "O Lord, I have once killed one Egyptian and I fear that for that they will kill me in return. I also fear they will reject me and call me a liar. Since you have given me this high office, I beg of you, expand for me my breast with light and make this task easy for me, and remove from my tongue the knot that is there: so that people may understand me.

And since I have no fluency in my tongue, and my brother Haroon is more eloquent than me, so please honour him also with Prophethood and join him with me in this task."

Allah responded, consoling him that he should take the message and show Fir'own the right path. "He will not be able to harm you. My help will be with you. And the signs we have granted you will be your source of success. In the end you will be successful. We have granted your requests and have made your brother Haroon your partner in this task. And when you proceed to Fir'own and his people to call them to guidance, speak to them in kindly sweet terms. Perhaps he may accept sound advice, fear Allah and desist from injustice and persecution."

"And so the fair promise of your Lord was fulfilled for the children of Israel because they had patience and constancy And we levelled to the ground the great works and fine buildings which Fir'own and his people erected." (7:137)

"And he was arrogant and insolent in the land, beyond reason, He and his hosts: they thought that they would not have to return to us."

Then we seized him and his hosts and we flung them into the Sea.

Now behold what was the end of those who did wrong." (28:39—40)

"How many were the gardens and springs they left behind?

And corn fields and noble buildings,
And wealth (and conveniences of life)
where in they had taken such delight.

Thus (was their and)

And we made other people inherit (those things).

And neither heavens nor earth shed a tear over them: No, were they given a respite (again).

(64:27—28)

MUSA عليه السلام RETURNS TO EGYPT AND HAZRAT HAROON عليه السلام RECEIVES PROPHETHOOD

Entry to Egypt

After Hazrat Musa عليه السلام had been honoured with Prophethood and favoured which conversing with Allah and after having been given the good news of his eventual success in his mission, he returned from the sacred valley back to where his wife was awaiting his return. From there he took his wife with him as he set forth enroute to Egypt. When he finally reached Egypt, it was night time. Quietly he reached the family home without entering it. He appeared as a traveller arriving at a home well-known for its hospitality towards strangers. The mother acted most hospitably towards them.

Then, his big brother Haroon arrived. Haroon had in the meantime also been blessed with Prophethood and through revelation he had been informed of Musa (*Alaihis Salām*)'s whole story. He embraced Musa عليه السلام and then took them into the house and informed the mother of the whole situation. The whole family was called and all of them met Musa عليه السلام and was told of his previous year's experiences.

When the mother met them she was greatly pleased.

Preaching the Truth in Fir'owns Court

After the two brothers had met each other, they decided among themselves that they will have to go to Fir'own in accordance with the command of Allah. They both reached the court of Fir'own and entered without any fear. As they neared his throne they explained the reason for their coming and started to speak:

"Musa  said: O Fir'own! I am a messenger from the cherisher and creator of the worlds. It is not fitting for me express to you from Allah's side anything else but the truth and what is correct. I have brought to you signs from Allah. So send Bani Israel with me (and release them from slavery). (7: 104—105)

Fir'own replied:

"Did we not cherish you as a child among us and did you not stay among us many years of your life? And you did a deed of yours, which (you know) you did. And you are truly ungrateful. (26:19)

Musa  replied:

"I did it when I was in error.

So I fled from you when I feared you.

But my Lord has since invested me with judgement (and wisdom) and appointed me as one of his Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*)."

And this is the favour with which you reproach me and you have enslaved the children of Israel."

Then Fir'own asked:

"And what is the Cherisher and Creator of the worlds?"

Nabi Musa ﷺ responded: "He is that Being who created you as well as your fore-fathers before you. It was He who brought you and your fore father's into existence and Cherished you.

When Fir'own heard this he told the courtiers: "I fear that this man who calls himself a Prophet and messenger is a mad man.

Nabi Musa ﷺ noticed that Fir'own could not form any answer to his reply, decided to continue to expound Allah's qualities of cherishing and he continued: "He is the Creator and Lord of all that lies in the East and the west and what lies in between them. All these are His creations. Him do I call the *Rabbul Aalameen*. If only you should use your reason, you will realize this with ease."

Then Nabi Musa ﷺ again reminded him that the path which he had chosen was wrong. The Lord of the worlds is the only one who is deserving of being worshipped and to accept anyone else as cherisher is '*Shirk*'.

"O Fir'own desist. The Lord of the worlds have revealed unto me that he who opposes this truth and rejects it or turns away from it, will be considered as deserving His punishment."

"Verily it has been revealed to us that the penalty awaits those who reject and turn away. (20:48)

Thereupon Fir'own repeated his question: "who, then, O Musa ﷺ is the Lord of you two?"

Nabi Musa ﷺ responded: "Our Lord is He who gave to each created thing its form and nature and further gave it guidance."

Fir'own inquired: "What is the condition of previous generations."

Musa ﷺ replied: "The knowledge of that is with my Lord, duly recorded my Lord never errs or forgets.

He who has made for you the earth as a carpet, spread out, has enabled you to go about therein by roads (and channels). And has sent down rain from the Sky and with it produced diverse pairs of plants Each separate from the other.

Eat (for yourself) and pasture your cattle.

Verily in this are signs for men endued with understanding. From this earth did we create you, and into it shall we return you And from it shall into it shall we return you And from it shall we bring you out once again."

(20: 52—54)

Haroon (Alaihis Salām)'s Actions

The *Ulama* of *Tafseer* state that during the course of the conversation between Fir'own and Nabi Musa ﷺ, Nabi Haroon ﷺ served as Musa (Alaihis Salām)'s interpreter and his duty was to relate Nabi Musa (Alaihis Salām)'s words and arguments with clear proofs and in more eloquent terms and this is what he did.

Fir'own's Reaction

The above type of conversations continued in various gatherings. Then in the end Fir'own said to his people by way of ending off the talks:

O people I know of no other god for you except myself." (28:38)

Then he ordered his adviser: "O Haamaan! Prepare for me a very high palace so that I may attain the ways and means.

The ways and means of reaching the heavens and that I may mount up to the God of Musa ﷺ. But as far as I am concerned I think (Musa ﷺ) is a liar." (40:36—37)

Haamaan

As far as Haamaan is concerned the Qur'ān does not specifically state whether it is the name of a person or the name of an official post. Neither does the Qur'ān state who then he actually prepared such a building or not. The Torah also is silent upon this point.

Exhibition in Fir'own's Court

Fir'own's opposition increased all the while until he said:

"If you have another god besides me, I shall surely imprison you." (29:22)

Musa ﷺ replied: "Will you do that even after I have brought to you clear signs?"

Fir'own said: "If indeed you have come with a sign, show it, if you are telling the truth." (7:106)

Thereupon Nabi Musa ﷺ stepped forward and threw down his staff in front of Fir'own. Immediately it changed into a large snake without being deceit of their eyes. Then he cast his hand into his bosom and as he extracted it was shining like a star.

When the courtiers saw how their King was defeated in this conservation and saw the Israelite bringing forth these miracles they became agitated and in anguish exclaimed: "Without doubt this is a very skilful sorcerer and magician. He has done all devised this deceitful trick that he may be victorious over you and take you out of your land. Now we must think what we are to do."

Finally it was decided among them that some respite should be granted to Musa ﷺ and Haroon ﷺ for the time being. After further consultation among them it was decided that they should gather all the skilful magicians from all over the Kingdom in the capital so that they can oppose Musa ﷺ in combat. They were certain that Musa ﷺ would be defeated and all his intentions will come to naught. Then Fir'own said to Musa ﷺ:

"We understand full well that your intention is to put us out of Egypt. Hence it is best that we shall gather all the skilful Magicians to defeat you. Now there should be a fixed day agreed to between you and us to when the confrontation shall be, after which neither will you be able to pull out of it and neither will we be able to withhold ourselves from the agreement."

Nabi Musa ﷺ answered: "It is best that confrontation should take place on the day called '*Yawm-uz-Zeenat*'- the festival day. On that day as the sun rises in the heavens we should gather on the plain."

Note: The Egyptians had a festival day called '*Wafa-an-Neel*'. This was considered the greatest festival day of the year.

And so it was agreed on '*Yawm-uz-Zeenat*'. Fir'own immediately sent a message to all over his Kingdom that

wherever there was a skilful magician, he should be sent to the capital as soon as possible.

Finally the '*Yawm-uz-Zeenat*' arrived with all his royal pomp and splendour Fir'own was sitting on his throne on the plain. Ground him the courtiers were arranged according to their ranks. Thousands of spectators had come to see the confrontation between truth and false-hood. On the one side were all the famous Egyptian magicians from all over the Kingdom with all their tools. On the other side stood Allah's Messenger ﷺ and his brother Haroon ﷺ.

The Magicians came to Fir'own and asked: "If we today defeat Musa ﷺ and are victorious over him, will there be a reward and special honour for us.

Fir'own replied: "Undoubtedly, Not only that, you will also become of the near and honoured ones in our court."

After the Magicians had received this assurance they turned to Nabi Musa ﷺ and Musa ﷺ told them: "Fir'own you! do not fabricate a lie against Allah. Let it not be such that He send a punishment, which will destroy you. Whoever fabricates lies against Allah will not be successful.

Then the Magicians said: "O Musa ﷺ, either, you throw down your staff or we will throw down."

Musa ﷺ replied: "You, throw down."

When the magicians had thrown their sticks and ropes, the people's eyes were deceived and terror was struck into them. For they showed a great feat of Magic." (7:116)

Then Allah revealed to Musa ﷺ: "Throw down your staff."

As he threw his staff and the snake ate up all that they had thrown down and in this way the truth became manifest

and their actions became naught. They were defeated."

(7:117—118)

When the Magicians saw the miracle all of them fell into prostration and said: "We believe in Lord who is the Lord of Musa ﷺ and Haroon ﷺ."

Seeing this Fir'own exclaimed:

"What, do you believe in Musa ﷺ without my permission?

Surely he is your leader who taught you magic.

See what I am going to do! I shall cut off your hands and feet on opposite sides and I will crucify you on date palm trees."

However when true *Iman* enters into a person, even if but for a short while, it creates such spiritual strength that no power in the world, no matter how strong cannot cause him to fear.

The result was that the threats of Fir'own could not cast fear into the hearts of the Magicians: They declared:

"We cannot turn away from the clear proofs of the truth shown to us today and from that Allah who created us to obey your orders. Do whatever you wish. You can only decree regarding the life of this world. We have accepted faith in our Lord that He may pardon our faults especially our faults in working Magic which you forced us to do. For us Allah is best and He is the everlasting one." (20: 72—73)

Hence in this confrontation between truth and false hood, Fir'own and his supporters had a great defeat and he was humiliated in the

presence of all. And Allah was true to His promise as Musa ﷺ was victorious. Moreover apart from the Magicians a small group of Israelites became followers of Musa ﷺ.

"But none believed in Musa ﷺ except some children of his people, Because of the fear of Fir'own and his chiefs lest they should persecute them." (10:83)

Having noticed to limited success of Nabi Musa ﷺ a group from among the people of Fir'own said to him: "will you leave Musa ﷺ and his people to spread mischief in the land and to abandon you and your gods? Fir'own said: "We will slay their male children and their females we will leave alive (to become slave-girls)." (7:127)

This was Fir'own's second announcement regarding the children of Bani Israel.

The Anxiety of Bani Israel

When Nabi Musa ﷺ came to know of the actions Fir'own and his courtiers planned against Bani Israel, he gathered the Israelites and advised them to have patience and to rely on Allah. They heard him and answered: "O Musa ﷺ we were caught up in calamities before this. Since you have appeared we have had hopes of improvements, but now we are still caught up in those same miseries. Now we are facing great hardship."

Nabi Musa ﷺ consoled them that Allah's promise is true. "Fear not. You will be victorious in the end. Your enemy will have to face destruction. Remember the Master of this earth is not Fir'own or his people, but Allah the Lord of the worlds who is One invested with complete authority. And

whosoever of His servants he wishes its make to master, he makes the Masters. And the good ending is for the righteous ones."

He told them:

"The evil deeds and injustices of Fir'own are not yet at an end. He is still not agreeable to allow the Israelites and capture believers to leave Egypt."

Then he prayed: "O Allah, for the wealth you have given Fir'own, instead of him being grateful, he practises tyranny and injustice on your servants. And neither does he accept the path of truth, nor does he allow others to accept it. He uses all force to stop them. Now Lord, let him taste his evil deed's. Destroy his wealth, about which he is so proud, and just as he kicks against the truth of *Imān*, let it be that instead being enriched with the wealth of *Imān*, a terrible punishment should overtake him that will be a lesson for others.

The Reaction of Fir'own

Fir'own was still burning on the inside for the defeat he suffered at the hands of Nabi Musa عليه السلام and even at his order to kill the male children of Bani Israel he did not derive peace of mind. Finally he said: "Let me kill Musa عليه السلام. Let him then call his Lord."

Nabi came to hear of this and said: "I seek refuge in my Lord and your Lord from a very proud and arrogant one who does not believe in the day of Reckoning."

The Believing Egyptian

While Fir'own and his chiefs were having this conversation, there was in their gathering an Egyptian

believers in Musa عليه السلام who upto now was keeping his conversion to Islam secret. He started defending Nabi Musa عليه السلام against his own chiefs saying that they wish to kill somebody for speaking the truth, "that my Lord is Allah" and who has brought some clear signs to prove the truth of his message. "Even if he is a liar, then his untruthfulness will cause you no harm. And if he is truthful, then fear the warnings which he recites to you from Allah's side."

Fir'own then cut short the speech of the believer: "I give you that advice which I consider correct in my view and utter a word in your interest. The believer then continued: "O my people, I fear lest our condition become like the people of Nooh, Aad and Thamood, or others after then. Allah does not perform any injustice against any people but those people's destruction were as a result of their own deeds. Whatever you are planning against Musa عليه السلام today, you are today is the process of thinking about your own position. I fear for you that day of *Qiyamat* when one will call the other but on that day there will be no one to save you from the punishment of Allah."

O chiefs of the people, you are such that when Yusuf عليه السلام came to deliver Allah's message, your fathers were caught up in doubts and refused to believe in him. And when he died, you said: "Now Allah will not send any Messenger." Now you do the same to Musa عليه السلام. For Allah's sake, understand and choose the right path."

When Fir'own and chiefs heard this speech of the Egyptian believer, their attention was drawn away from Musa عليه السلام to this man, and Fir'own intended to first deal with him and finish him off. But Allah did not allow him to carry out this intention and saved him from their evil intention.

Fir'own's Annoucement

When Fir'own and his chiefs failed to defeat Musa ﷺ, he announced among his people: "O people, am I not the master of the throne? And is not the rivers flowing under the feet of my government? Do you not see my glory and splendour? Am I superior or this one who has no honour and is unable to speak properly? If indeed he (is honoured in Allah's sight), then why does not golden bracelets fall down upon him from the heavens and why does not the angels come with him accompanying him in procession."

The Wrath of Allah on the Egyptians

The Message of guidance brought by Hazrat Musa ﷺ had absolutely no effect on Fir'own and his chiefs and apart from very few all the other Egyptians followed him and in response to Fir'own's call they began to kill the male children of Bani Israel. They started degrading Nabi Musa ﷺ and Fir'own started spreading the belief in his lordship and divinity.

Then Allah revealed to Nabi Musa ﷺ to inform Fir'own that it that trend was going to continue then Allah's punishment was going to descend. Thereupon Fir'own and his people paid no attention, then one after the other various forms of punishment descended upon them. Fir'own then adopted this strategy: when a certain form of calamity descended they told Musa ﷺ that they promise to believe. He should pray to Allah to remove the calamity. And once Musa ﷺ had prayed and the calamity was removed he went bad on his promise.

Another calamity would descent and again he would promise to allow Bani Israel to leave Egypt, and again

Musa ﷺ would pray to the calamity to be removed only for Fir'own to go back on his word.

In this manner various calamities by way of punishment descended. The Qur'ān puts it thus:

"And we punished the people of Fir'own with years of drought and shortness of crops that they might receive admonition....

So we sent in them plagues, whole sale death, locusts, lice frogs and bloody signs openly self explained."

(7:130—133)

In the verse the *Muffassireen* have written about the lice and the frogs, that it so happened that there was not a thing in Egypt which people ate or wore or used in which these things did not appear. As for as blood was concerned, the water of the Nile turned to blood and the bloody taste, and smell of it made it very difficult to drink. Even the fish in the water died.

As for lice, this is a word with very wide meanings. The best way to understand it is that Allah sent a plague of lice over Egypt. This caused smell flies to be produced in all eatables which in turn caused destructive worms to be produced which caused a kind of insect of to be produced in grains. All those destructive worms and insects are called 'lice'.

Bani Israel's Departure form Egypt

When matters became such that even these curses which descended on Egypt could not affect them, Allah informed Nabi Musa ﷺ: "Now the time has come for you to take Bani Israel from Egypt to the land of their fore fathers." Hence Nabi Musa ﷺ and Haroon ﷺ secretly took Bani Israel by

night in the direction of the Red Sed. Before they left they did not even hand back to the Egyptian women their jewelery and costly materials, which they had borrowed from them on the occasion of a special festival day. They feared that they did that the Egyptians would come to know of their plan to flee from Egypt.

Fir'own's Drowning

Nabi Musa ﷺ consoled the Israelites: "Do not fear! Allah's promise is true. He will save you. and you will be victorious."

"They went forth and reached the Red Sea. Then Allah informed Nabi Musa ﷺ by revelation: "Strike your staff upon the sea so that the water can split open, and a road can appear through it."

Nabi Musa ﷺ did as he was ordered and immediately the water split and pulled up on two sides, standing like two mountains. In between the two sides a road opened up. At his command the whole of Bani Israel took this road and crossed over to the other side.

When Fir'own arrived there, saw this, and told his soldiers: "This is my miracle that you should catch Bani Israel."

The whole army with Fir'own proceeded forward and took the same road through the sea. But after Bani Israel had reached the other side safely, the water returned to its original form on the order of Allah. Thus Fir'own and his whole army who were still half way across were drowned on the Red Sea.

When Fir'own was drowning and he saw the Angels of Allah, bringing punishment, he called out: " I believe in that being a which Bani Israel believes and I am a Muslim, submitting unto Him."

He accepted Islam at last. But in actual fact it was not true *Imān*; but like his previous deceitful declarations it was merely uttered to acquire salvation, Allah answered him thus: "Ah now! But a little while before you were in rebellion and did mischief." (10:91)

In other words Allah declared: "You are not of the Muslimeen, but of the *Mufsideen* (evil-doors).

What actually happened was that on seeing the punishment of Allah in front of him Fir'own called out in this way in an involuntary manner, which was not out of choice. It was not to acquire *Imān* and *Yaqeen*. It was in answer to Nabi Musa (*Alaihis Salām*)'s prophecy:

"So they will not believe until they see the grievous penalty."

Allah said: "Accepted O Musa and Haroon is your prayer." (10:85)

Allah further declares:

"This day we shall save you in your body that you may be a sign to those who come after you. (10:92)

Note: In the Egyptian Museum in Cairo there is a corpse preserved up till today. It seems that having been drowned in the sea, the fish had eaten his nose off. It is said this corpse is the corps of the Fir'own of the time of Nabi Musa , called Merneptah. And Allah knows best.

The Qur'ān has told the story of Bani Israel's departure from Egypt and Fir'own's drowning in very concise terms as well as how Bani Israel was saved. All these were given in broad out lines and has mentioned the lessons in considerable detail. He says:

"And we sent an inspiration to Musa: Travel by night with my servants and strike a dry path for them through the sea without fear of being overtaken (by Fir'own) and without (any other) fear.

Then Fir'own pursued them with his forces but the waters completely overwhelmed them and covered them up.

Fir'own lad his people astray instead of leading them aright." (20: 77—79)

A Great Miracle

The Holy Qur'ān clearly states that the drowning of Fir'own and the departure of Nabi Musa ﷺ and the Israelites through the Red Sea was a great miracle which was granted to Nabi Musa ﷺ as a support for him. It was such a miracle which defeated all the worldly and material forces of evil and liberated an oppressed and persecuted people. "And Allah has power over all things."

Says Allah in the Qur'ān: "We delivered Musa ﷺ and all who were with him.

But we drowned the others

Verily in this is a sign, But most of them do not believe.

And verily your Lord is He, the Exalted in Might, Most Merciful." (26: 67—69)

Fir'own and the Day of Qiyamat

The battle between Nabi Musa ﷺ and Fir'own, between truth and false hood is one of the greatest battles ever. On the one side there was arrogance and pride, tyranny and

injustice, brute strength and the humiliation of selfishness and disgrace and on the other side was an oppressed people, worship of Allah, patience and the victory of the steadfastness and the strange success of the poor ones.

For this reason after the defeat of Fir'own in this world, Allah has drawn attention to the valuable lessons in this and has indicated that for such people in the here after there will be a grave punishment.

"In front of the fire will they be brought morning and evening (and the sentence will be)

On the day of judgement will be established:

"Cast the people of Fir'own into the severest penalty."

(60:45—46)

NABI MUSA ﷺ AND BANI ISRAEL AFTER CROSSING THE RED SEA

Their First Demand

After the Israelites had crossed the Red Sea, they took the road through the barren desert in the direction of Sinai. There they saw the inhabitants worshipping idols in temples. Seeing this they came to Nabi Musa ﷺ and demanded: "O Musa ﷺ make for us also such gods that we may worship them"

When Musa ﷺ heard this polytheistic request, he became very angry and scolded them in harsh terms: "O you wretched ones;! You want to discard the worship of the one true God and go towards worshipping idols! Did you forget all the favours Allah had just shown you after seeing them with your own eyes?"

Allah's Favours on Bani Israel

Bani Israel were now in the Valley of Sinai where it was very hot.. from where they were to far off there was no greenery and no water. Bani Israel requested water and Musa ﷺ prayed to Allah. Revelation came to him to strike his staff against the earth.

Nabi Musa ﷺ did as he was ordered and immediately twelve fountains opened up so that each tribe of Bani Israel had their own watering place.

Manna and Salwa

Now after having found water Bani Israel felt hunger and once again Nabi Musa ﷺ prayed for food. Once again his *Du'a* was answered: It so happened that when morning broke, Bani Israel saw that on the earth and the trees something like dew was descending from the sky. When they ate it, it tasted like sweet meats. This was called 'Manna.'

Then during the day a strong wind blew and then swarms of birds descended. All they had to do was catch the birds and slaughter them and eat. This was the Salwa.

The Shade of Clouds

Then they complained of the great heat of the sun and not finding the shade of trees or houses. Again Nabi Musa ﷺ prayed to Allah and the *Du'a* was answered. Clouds came along and granted shade to them in the desert. Wherever they want the clouds and shade followed them.

The Ingratitude of Bani Israel

How could Bani Israel be adequately grateful for all the favours of Allah. One day they said: "O Musa ﷺ, every day we eat the one type of food of which we are now tired."

We do not need this "*Manna wa Salwa*." Pray to your Lord to grant us of what the earth produces, cabbage cucumbers, daal, garlic and onions, so that we may eat thereof.

Musa ﷺ answered: "Do you exchange good things for things not so good. Go and settle in a town. Surely there you will find all those things. (2:61)

Aetikaaf on Mount Toor

Allah had promised that after Bani Israel had been saved from slavery, He will grant him the *Shariat*. Now Bani Israel had reached Mount Toor. and Nabi Musa ﷺ went up the mountain to spend time in Allah's worship while he performed *Aetikaaf*.

"And we appointed for Musa ﷺ thirty nights and completed (the period) with ten (more). Thus was completed the term of communion with his Lord forty nights (7:142)

When Nabi Musa ﷺ went up the mountain to spend forty days:

"And Musa ﷺ had charged his brother Haroon ﷺ (before we went up) 'Act for me against my people. Do right and follow not the way of those who do mischief."

The Manifestation of Allah

When the forty days were completed, Allah honoured Nabi Musa ﷺ by holding conversation with him. Musa ﷺ said:

"O Lord, Show yourself to me, that I may look upon you."

Allah said: "By no means can you see Me.

But look upon the mount: If it abide in its place then shall you see Me."

When his Lord manifested His glory on the mount, He made it as dust and Musa ﷺ fell into a swoon when he recovered his senses he said:

"Glory be to you! To you I turn in repentance
and I am the first to believe." (7:143)

The Revelation of the Torah

After this secret conversation Allah revealed the Torah to him.

"And we ordained laws for him in the tablets in all matters, both commanding and explaining all things (and said) take and hold these with firmness and enjoin your people to hold fast; by the best in the precepts." (7:145)

And so was the Torah revealed and together with it, it was also declared that : Our Law is this that if a people after guidance had reached them and clear proof and arguments and in spite thereof, they refuse to use their minds and remain on their wrong ways and stick to the ways of their fore fathers and customs, insisting thereupon, We will leave them on their astray path and there will be for them no portion of our Message of truth because through their disobedience they had moved from themselves the capability of accepting the truth."

The Worship of the Cow

During this time a strange incident happened. Taking advantage of Nabi Musa ﷺ absence from Bani Israel while

he was in *Aetikaaf* on the mountain, a certain by the name of Saamiry did some mischief.

(According to Maulana Abul Kalam Azad this man was not of Bani Israel, but a member of the people of Sumeria)

Out worldly he was a Muslim. He told Bani Israel: "If you can hand me the jewellery which was borrowed from the Egyptians and which you could no hand back to them before leaving Egypt, then I will show you something for your benefit."

Bani Israel handed all the jewellery to him. He melted the jewellery and made a form of cow out of it. Then from his own side he added a handful of sand into it and through this some signs of life appeared in it and it started to utter a sound. Then he told Bani Israel: "Musa ﷺ has made mistake. This is your God."

At his indication Bani Israel started worshipping the cow.

Allah informed Musa ﷺ of this happening. Allah asked him:

"O Musa ﷺ, Why did you leave your people and hasten here?"

Musa ﷺ replied:

"I hurried towards you, Lord, to acquire guidance for my people."

Then Allah informed him that the people for whose guidance he did so much and on behalf of whom he is so anxious, have been led astray. Hearing this, Musa ﷺ was greatly saddened and returned to his people with anger and sorrow. Facing them he said: "What is this you have done?"

Did I stay away from you so long that you had to get involved in this calamity?"

At the time he was very angry, and in his anger the Torah tablets fell from his hands.

The Israelites replied: This is not our fault. It is the burden of the jewellery of the Egyptians which we carried along with us. That is what Saamiry requested from us out of which he made this form and misled us.

'Shirk' associating anything unto Allah is such a crime, which cannot be tolerated. Musa ﷺ was very hot tempered. He grabbed his brother Haroon by the neck and stretched his hand towards his beard to hold him by it.

Haroon ﷺ exclaimed: "O brother, it is not my fault. I have tired my utmost to prohibit them, but they would not heed. They said that for as long as Musa ﷺ does not return, we won't listen to you."

In fact, finding me weak, they even planned to kill me. When I saw this, I thought that if I should fight against them, and a battle should ensue between the true believers and them, then the accusation could be laid at my door, that I have caused a division among Bani Israel. Therefore I preferred silence as I awaited your return. Beloved brother, do not hold me by the head or by my beard so that others do not find a chance to laugh at us."

Hearing this explanation from Haroon ﷺ, Nabi Musa (Alaihis Salām)'s anger subsided, and he turned in the direction of Saamiry:

"Saamiry, what is this nonsense you have made?"

He replied:

"I have seen something which these Israelites did not see.

(At the time of the drowning of Fir'own), I saw Jibreal on a horse between the forces of Fir'own and the Israelites. I have noticed that in the dust under the hoofs of the horse there were signs of life and that from the dry green earth fire came forth. So I took, handful of dust from under the hoofs of the horse. This I threw into the statue of the cow and signs of life was created in it and a voice came forth from it."

Nabi Musa ﷺ said:

"Now for you in this world this will be your punishment: you will roam around in the world like a mad man. When any person comes near to you, you will flee from him and say: "Don't touch me!" This will be your punishment in this world and on the Day of *Qiyamat* there will be a special punishment. that will surely be fulfilled in your case."

O Saamiry, the cow which you have made into an idols, we shall cast it into the fire to be burnt to dust, so it become known to the foolish ones has no power or no strength and cannot even do any harm or benefit to anyone, neither can it save itself from destruction.

The Pardon of Bani Israel

After Nabi Musa (*Alaihis Salām*)'s anger had subsided, he picked up the tablets of the Torah and returned to Allah asking what deed would be the pardon of the Israelites who had been guilty of this irreligious deed which actually constituted apostly. The answer came that those guilty of the evil must now kill themselves.

There is a report in Sahih Nisai Shareef that Nabi Musa ﷺ told Bani Israel that there is only one way of repenting

for their evil deed, viz that those guilty of it should kill themselves in this way that the one nearest in blood relationship should do the killing, that is the father should kill the son and the son should kill the father and brother should kill brother. In the end Bani Israel was forced to accept this punishment as a deed of repentance and pardon. Many of Bani Israel were killed in this manner.

Finally when many had been killed Nabi Musa ﷺ prayed to Allah: "O Allah! Now have mercy on them and forgive for them their fault."

Allah accepted the *Du'a* and announced: "We have pardoned both the killer and the killed one, as well as the living one who was guilty. Now tell them that in future they should not even go near to any form of '*Shirk*'".

The Appointment of Seventy Chiefs

After the Israelites had their crime pardoned Nabi Musa ﷺ told them: "These tablets which are with me is Allah's Book which He revealed to me for your guidance and for your worldly as well as religious life and its success. It is the Torah. You are required to believe in it and to follow its instructions.

They asked him: "O Musa , how do we know, for sure, that it is Allah's Book?

We will not merely believe because you say so. We will believe when we shall see Allah with our own eyes and He tells us that this Torah is His Book."

Nabi Musa ﷺ explained to them that is a foolish question and request. "You will not be able to see Him."

However their demand was insisted upon. Nabi Musa ﷺ thought about it and then said to them: "This is impossible

that you in your hundreds of thousands should come with me to Horeb on Mount Toor, to confirm Allah's Book.

I think it is best that you choose some chiefs from among you to go with me. And when they come back after confirmation, then you must also accept. And moreover, because of you worship of the cow you committed a big sin, it now seems advisable that you should also exhibit your sorrow and regret and make a promise to continue good works in future."

They agreed with this proposal and Nabi Musa ﷺ chose seventy chiefs and took them with him to mount Toor. On the mountain a white cloud enveloped Nabi Musa ﷺ and he began to talk to Allah: He said:

"O Allah you are fully aware of the condition of Bani Israel. I have chosen seventy men from among them and brought them to you how nice would it not be if they could listen to my conversation with you so that they can return to their people and confirm."

Allah accepted Musa (*Alaihis Salām*)'s plea and they all were entered into the 'curtain of light' and they listened to the conversation between Musa ﷺ and Allah.

The Obstinacy of the Chiefs and Allah's Punishment

When the curtain of light was removed, and Nabi Musa ﷺ and the chiefs came face to face, the chiefs repeated their original demand, that they would not believe in the Torah unless they see Allah with out any curtain in between. Due to this foolish insistence and obstinacy Allah's wrath came in the form of a frightening lightning and thunder and an earthquake came along and burnt them all to ashes.

When Nabi Musa ﷺ saw this, he prayed:

"O Allah, these foolish ones have surely been guilty of foolishness. Will you then destroy as all for it?

O Allah through your Mercy, forgive them."

Allah heard Musa (*Alaihis Salām*)'s *Du'a* and brought them all back to life."

The Qur'ān says:

"And remember you said: O Musa, we shall never believe in you, until we see Allah manifestly, But you were dazed with thunder and lightning even as you looked on.

Then we raised you up after your death:

You had the chance to be grateful." (2:55)

Bani Israel's Second Refusal and Mount Toor

When the seventy chiefs after being brought back to life returned to their people, they told the others that whatever Nabi Musa ﷺ had told them was true and that he was sent by Allah.

It would have been natural for them that they should be grateful to Allah and show obedience to Him, but it so happened that soon thereafter they again showed their obstinacy and in spite of the confirmation by the seventy chiefs, they again refused to accept the Torah, bringing all kinds of excuses and objections.

When Nabi Musa ﷺ saw this, he again complained to Allah of their attitude. And Allah revealed to Nabi Musa ﷺ:

"With regard to these disobedient ones, I give you one more miraculous sign: viz On that same mountain on which I conversed with you and where your seventy chiefs saw what they saw, I shall command that same mountain to move from its place and to become suspended over Bani Israel like a roof and to declare silently that Musa ﷺ is the true Messenger of Allah and that the Torah is Allah's true Book and if these two facts were not true you would not see this event happening.

As soon as Allah's decision was made Mt Toor moved from its place and became like a roof canopy over Bani Israel saying: "O Bani Israel, if there is reason and understanding in you and the ability to differentiate between truth and falsehood, then listen with an ear of truth, I am a special sign from Allah to indicate to you and to bear witness that Musa ﷺ has on various occasions had conversations with Allah on my back and the Torah as a Book of guidance was also received by him on my back.

O you evil ones of rebellion and disobedience; This posture of mine which surprises you, is to bear witness that when the softness of a person's heart changes to hardness he can become as hard as a piece of stone and even harder and as such no guidance can enter it. I am a collection of stones but in front of Allah's order I submit completely but you in your selfishness and arrogance are not even prepared to change your 'no' for a "yes."

Qur'ān states:

"Hence forth were your hearts hardened like a rock and even more worse in hardness." (2:74)

The result was that Bani Israel saw this and felt fear in them and they declared openly to follow the Torah and declared before Nabi Musa ~~ﷺ~~ that they accept it. Then Allah said to them: "Whatever we have given you, hold onto it fast and follow its instructions that you may become pious and god fearing."

It is a pity that in spite of this solemn declaration that Bani Israel could not live up to their covenant for very long. It was not much later when they again started acting contrary to their promises: The Qur'ān puts it thus:

"And remember we took your covenant and we raised above you (the towering height of) Mt. Sinai saying. Hold firmly to what we have given you. And bring ever to remembrance what is there in perhaps you may fear Allah. (2:3)

But you turned back there after.

Had it not been for the Grace and Mercy of Allah to you, You had surely been among the lost.'

(2:63—64)

Further:

"And when we shook the mount over them, as if it had been a canopy and they thought it was going to fall on them (we said): Hold firmly to what we have given you. And bring ever to remembrance what is therein perchance you may fear Allah."

(7:171)

The Promise of the Holy Land

Note: The Holy Land is that area which was first known as Canaan and later became known as Palestine.

The area in which Bani Israel was quite near to Palestine and it was Allah's promise to Ibraheem ﷺ, Ishaq ﷺ and Ya'qoob ﷺ that He would bring their children back to become owners of the land where they will flourish. Therefore Allah told Nabi Musa ﷺ to order the Israelites to enter the Holy Land and to remove from there the unjust tyrannical rulers and to introduce a life of peace and justice. Allah promised that He would grant them victory and their unjust enemies would be vanquished.

Before Nabi Musa ﷺ ordered them to enter the land, he chose twelve men to investigate the conditions in the land. Then entered the city of Areeha (Jericho) and investigated conditions thoroughly. On their return they informed Nabi Musa ﷺ that the people were strong and well-built with powerful forms.

Nabi Musa ﷺ told them not to disclose these facts to the people because, having been in virtual slavery for a long time, they had lost courage and bravery and instead had been filled with cowardice, humiliation and lack of courage. These men were however part of the nation and went to tell their people the whole story of the enemy's strength, exaggerating it even more. Only two of the men i.e. Yusha bin Noon and Kaalib bin Yafna did not tell their people. They refrained from any such actions which would let their people lose courage.

Then Nabi Musa ﷺ told the Israelites to enter the Holy Land, Jericho, fight the enemy and take possession of the land as the Qur'ān states: "Remember Musa ﷺ said to his people: O My people, call in remembrance the favour of Allah unto you when he produced prophets among you. Made you Kings and gave you what He had not given to any among the Peoples.

O My people enter the Holy Land which Allah had assigned unto you and turn not back ignominiously for then, you will be overthrown to your own ruin. (5:22—23)

Bani Israel's Disobedience

Bani Israel replied: "O Musa ﷺ, there are some very strong people living there. We shall not enter that town until they depart from it. It is a pity that these unfortunate beings did not think that how were those strong men going to depart from the city unless they should chase them out."

When Yusha and Kaalib saw this, they encouraged their sections of the nation and told them it was no difficult feat for them to enter through the city gates. "They were to attack and Allah would make them victorious.

"But among their god fearing men were two on whom Allah had bestowed His Grace;

They said: Assault them at the gate
when once you are in, victory will be yours."

(5:25)

But on Allah put your trust

If you have faith."

However these words of inspiration had no effect on Bani Israel. They still insisted in their refusal to fight. When Musa ﷺ further encouraged them, they said:

"O Musa while they remain there never shall we be able to enter it to the end of time.

Go you and your Lord and fight you two while we sit here and watch."

(5:24)

When Nabi Musa ﷺ heard this uncouth reply he was very distressed and very sad and turned to Allah in prayer: "O Lord I only have power over myself and Haroon ﷺ, my brother. So separate us from this folk." (5:26)

Allah replied:

"Be not sad: Their disobedience is no burden upon you therefore will the land be out of their reach for forty years. In distruction will they wander through the land.

So be not sad over these rebellious people."

(5:29)

During that period Nabi Musa ﷺ and Haroon ﷺ also had to stay with them in that desert plain. They too were not allowed to enter the Holy Land because it was necessary for the guidance of Bani Israel that their Prophet and Messenger should be among them.

The Demise of Hazrat Haroon ﷺ

While Bani Israel was wandering in the desert like lost people, and they passed near to a mountain called 'Hoor' he received news of his impending death. Both he and Moosa ﷺ climbed onto Mount Hoor where for a couple of days they remained busy in 'Ibadat' there Nabi Haroon ﷺ passed away and Nabi Musa ﷺ took charge of his burial and funeral. When returned from there he informed Bani Israel of the death of Nabi Haroon ﷺ.

The Demise of Nabi Musa ﷺ

It is reported by Abu Hurayrah ؓ that when Musa (Alaihis Salām)'s death approached, one angel of death

appeared before him. After some conversation, Nabi Musa عليه السلام told Allah: "If after the longest life-span the end result will eventually be death, why shall death not come over me now? O Allah in my last moments, make it happen near the Holy Land."

According to the *Du'a* of Nabi Musa عليه السلام, his grave is found in the settlement of Jericho called '*Katheeb' Ahmar*' the Red hill. Which is also mentioned in one *Hadith*. It should be noted that in the plain of Teeh, the nearest valley of the holy land is the town of Jericho. It is as if we may say his last *Du'a* was also accepted.

Other Incidents During the Prophethood of Nabi Musa عليه السلام

Once it so happened that a murder took place among the Israelites, but there was no knowledge as to who the murderer was various accusation were made. Nabi Musa عليه السلام turned to Allah in his search for the murderer and he was ordered to kill a cow. Then he had to take a piece of the cow and touch the murdered man with it. This would cause the dead man to be brought back to life and he would say who the murder was.

When he told Bani Israel about the cow, they once again showed their absurd reasoning and argumentation nature. First they asked him:

"O Musa عليه السلام are you playing the fool with us?"

"And if that is really Allah's command, what colour of cow should it be?"

They wanted some more details. After Nabi had answered all their questions regarding the cow, then only were they prepared to carry out the order the murdered man became alive and he told the whole story of his murder so that even

the murderer had to confess to it and the matter was properly settled. But in the incident showed the trouble-some and hard-hearted nature of the Jews.

Nabi Musa ﷺ and Qaroon

There was a very rich man among the Israelites who was known by the name of Qaroon. His treasures consisted of many kinds of jewellery and gold. A group of strong powerful men was needed to pick up the keys which led to his treasure store-houses.

Because of his richness he had become quite arrogant and so affected was he by his affluence that he began to look down upon his other relations, and other members of society who were less fortunate than him.

Nabi Musa ﷺ and his people once advised him that Allah had endowed him with considerable wealth and riches with honour and dignity, there for he should at all times be grateful and express thanks and also that he should give the rights of his riches by giving alms and charity to the needy. They advised him that it was an act of ingratitude to forget Allah and to go against His orders and it is not the correct thing to look upon the weaker and power ones as being degraded and despicable. The selfishness and egoism in Qaroon did not like this advice and in a haughty manner replied: "This has been given to me because of a certain knowledge which I have."

"I cannot accept your advice and destroy my riches."
(29:78)

Nabi Musa ﷺ continued to convey the message and to show Qaroon the way. When Qaroon saw that Nabi Musa ﷺ did not desist from following him, he one day came out in all

splendour to exhibit his wealth and riches. At that time Nabi Musa ﷺ was preaching to Bani Israel, conveying Allah's message to them, as Qaroon passed by in all splendour, exhibiting his treasures. The intention was to show that although Nabi Musa ﷺ had the ear of the people, he also had quite a following among them by virtue of his wealth. His aim was to defeat Musa ﷺ by making use of his gold and jewels.

When Bani Israel saw his shine and splendour, through human weakness this idea settled in their hearts: "Alas! If only these riches and wealth and splendour would come to us too!"

However the men of understanding among Bani Israel quickly interfered and responded: "Behold! Don't go after these worldly adornments and do not allow yourself to be caught in this worldly greed. Soon you will see the evil results of this wealth and riches."

In the end after Qaroon had made a good display of his arrogance and pride and after having emphasised his degrading and humiliation of the Muslims from Bani Israel, Allah's wrath was stirred into action and his law of retribution came into force. Allah passed a decree against Qaroon and all his wealth. "Then we caused the earth to swallow up him and his house and he had not the least party to help him against Allah.

Nor could he defend himself." (28:81)

Bani Israel saw all this. His arrogance did not remain nor his goods. The earth swallowed everything up and so a lesson was produced for others the Qur'ān has told this story in broad terms and in more detail.

When did Qaroon's Incident Take Place?

The *Ulama* of *Tafseer* are divided over the issue of when this incident took place i.e., in Egypt before the drowning of

Fir'own or while they were wandering in the wilderness. The Qur'ān mentions the story after the events of Fir'own's drowning. Therefore in our opinion it happened while Bani Israel was wandering around in the desert.

Nabi Musa عليه السلام and Hazrat Khidr عليه السلام

Of the important incidents in the life of Nabi Musa عليه السلام is the meeting he had with a man of the inner sciences, from whom he learned some secret matters pertaining to the world of causes (*Takweeniyaat*). The meeting between him and this person is told in *Surah Kahf* and in Bukhari Shareef there are some more details.

In Bukhari it is reported by Saeed bin Jubair رضي الله عنه that he inquired from Abdullah bin Abbaas رضي الله عنه: "Nowf Bukkaali says that the Musa عليه السلام who is mentioned with Khidr is not the Musa عليه السلام of Bani Israel. It is another Musa عليه السلام."

Sayeduna Abdullah bin Abbaas رضي الله عنه replied: "The enemy of Allah is telling a lie. Ubay bin Kaab reported to me that he heard Rasulallah صلى الله عليه وسلم say: "One day Nabi Musa عليه السلام was addressing Bani Israel when a certain man asked him: "who in this age is the best scholar with most knowledge?"

Nabi Musa عليه السلام replied:

"I. Allah has given me most knowledge."

Allah was not pleased with this answer and as a result of the Nabi Musa عليه السلام was reprimanded: "For you it would have been filling to have said rather. Allah knows best."

Then it was revealed to him: Go to where the two seas are meeting. There you will find one of my servants who in some matters have more knowledge than you.

Nabi Musa ﷺ inquired: "How is the route to that servant of yours?"

Allah replied:

"Take a fish in your food box and where the fish will disappear, there you will find him."

Nabi Musa ﷺ took his tiffin box and placed a fish in it, and together with his successor Yusha bin Noon he took the road towards the place where the two seas meet, to meet the pious person. After traveling for some distance they slept on a big rock. There the fish became alive and escaped from the box and took its way into the sea. It began swimming in the water and where it swam the water turned to ice like a foot-path in the water.

Yusha saw all this as he woke up from sleep before Nabi Musa ﷺ did, but when Nabi Musa ﷺ woke up he forgot to relate the story to him. They resumed their journey further, traveling for another day and a night. The next day Nabi Musa ﷺ said to him: "Now tiredness has overtaken me. Bring the fish that we may drive off the hunger."

[Rasulallah ﷺ said that for Musa ﷺ to travel to their set destination they felt no weariness, but for traveling beyond that they felt the tiredness].

Then Yusha said to Nabi Musa ﷺ: "When we were sleeping on the big rock, the fish became alive in a wonderful way and took its way into the sea and as it swam in the sea it formed a path through the water. I have forgotten to relate this story to you. that is as a result of *Shaitan's* doing."

Musa ﷺ replied:

"That spot is the place we were searching for."

They immediately retraced their steps as they took the road back.

Finally they reached the rock and there they found a man dressed in fine clothing, sitting there. Nabi Musa عليه السلام greeted him: He answered:

"Where is this *Salaam* coming from in this land?"

This man was Sayeduna Khidr عليه السلام.

Nabi Musa عليه السلام said to him: "I have come to you to learn some of that knowledge which Allah had taught you.

Khidr عليه السلام replied: "If you stay with me, you will not be able to have patience to bear all those things. Allah has taught me such secrets of creation which He did not teach you and of *Shariah* knowledge He has given you what He did not give me.

Nabi Musa عليه السلام said: "*Insha'allah* you will find me patient and for bearing."

And I will not disobey you in the least.

Khidr عليه السلام replied:

"If you are to accompany me it will be on this condition that whatever your eyes will see, you will not question me about. I will in my own time explain things to you."

Nabi Musa عليه السلام agreed to the condition and the two of them proceeded in a certain direction. Finally they reached the coast of the sea and saw a boat. There Khidr asked the sailors about crossing over and the price. The sailors knew him and they refused to accept any payment. They took both

Musa ﷺ and Khidr aboard without payment. Before the journey had ended Khidr took out one of the planks in the front of the boat. Nabi Musa ﷺ could not tolerate this. He exclaimed: "The sailors had done us a favour by loading us on the boat without payment and now you pay them back by making a hole in the boat. This means the boat and sailors will all be drowned and perish. This is most unsuitable.

Khidr ﷺ replied:

"I told you before the time you will not be able to have patience with me. And that has happened."

Nabi Musa ﷺ said:

"I have completely forgotten about that. So do not blame me for not having remembered.

[Rasulallah ﷺ said that this first question by Musa ﷺ was truly as a result of having forgotten.]

Then as they sailed, a bird came along at the side of the boat and placed its beak into the water, taking a drop of water. Khidr saw this and said:

"This is an indication of your and mine knowledge in comparison with Allah's knowledge. Our knowledge is like that drop of water.

The boat reached the shore and the two of them disembarked. They walked along the shore until they reached an open plain where some children were playing. Khidr took one of the children and killed him. Once again Nabi Musa ﷺ could not bear it and he said: "You have taken the life of an innocent child without any justification. This is very bad.

Khidr ﷺ replied: "Did I not tell you from before that you will not be able to have patience with me?"

[Rasulallah ﷺ says that because this deed was more serious than the first one Nabi Musa ﷺ could not bear it].

Musa ﷺ said: "This time once more forgive me for questioning. If after this I again fail to have patience there will be no excuse for me, then you and I must part.

Once again they went along, until they came to a village where the people were in a good position to accept them as guests. However in spite of them asking to be taken as guests, they refused. They left and on the one side of the village came upon a house where they found a wall in such a condition that it was about to fall down, Khidr used his hands and straightened the wall preventing it from falling down. Nabi Musa ﷺ once again rebuked him: "We entered this village as travellers but the inhabitants refused to have us as guests and refused us to stay with them. Now you repaired the wall for one of their people without any payment. If you had to do it why could you not have agreed with them on a price so that we could use the price for our food and drink to drive of hunger and thirst."

Khidr ﷺ replied:

"Now is the time for you and me to part."

Then he began to explain to Musa ﷺ the three events, saying those three deeds were orders from Allah.

Important things about Khidr ﷺ

There are few things note worthy about Hazrat Khidr ﷺ.

- (1) Is Khidr a name or is it a nickname? Is he a pious person or a *Nabi* or *Rasul*?

- (i) Has he got everlasting life or has he died already?
 (ii) Where is the *Majma-ul-Bahrain*, the junction of the two seas?
 (iii) What is the rank of Hazrat Khidr عليه السلام ?

In the Qur'ān, neither is his name mentioned nor his nickname. He is only mentioned as "One of our servants." In Sahih Bukhari and Muslim he is mentioned, but even from there too could not be ascertained if Khidr is a name or a nickname, but this is not really necessary.

- (2) The most preferred verdict is that he was a Nabi. The manner in which the Qur'ān mentions him is a manner reserved for Prophets. The rank of sainthood (*Wilayat*) is beneath that of Prophets
- (3) It is the view of the research scholars of Islam (*Muhaqqiqeen*) that Khidr عليه السلام had already passed away because for all those in this world death is necessary.

The Qur'ān says:

"O Muhammad we granted not to any man before you permanent life: If you should die will they live permanently?" (21:34)

- (4) As for the *Majma-ul-Bahrain* the juncture of the two seas. Our Ustad Maulana Sayed Anwar Shah kashmiri's view was that this is the spot that today is called '*Aqaba*'
- (5) As for the rank of Hazrat Khidr عليه السلام, the Qur'ān stated about Khidr (*Alaihis Salām*'s knowledge, "that we have taught him knowledge from our own selves." And a *Surah Kahf* we have Khidr (*Alaihis Salām*)'s statement "that he did not do any of those things of his own self," but through Allah's command.

(Al-Kahf: 82)

From those sentences we deduce that Allah had granted him some inner secrets of the workings in the creation which is something he only grants to special servants of His, such secrets that if these become known to all others, the laws and regulations of this whole world would suffer. For this reason those matters should remain hidden to the ordinary man.

As for as the rank of Hazrat Musa عليه السلام is concerned, then because of being a Prophet and Messenger of Allah he is of higher rank than Khidr by virtue of being an eminent messenger of Allah and a bringer of a *Shariat* and also being a bringer of a Revealed Bood. Thus Khidr by virtues of being a knower of special *Takweeni* knowledge cannot surpass Musa عليه السلام in rank.

Trouble Caused to Hazrat Musa عليه السلام by Bani Israel

From the foregoing incidents it is quite clear that Bani Israel caused Hazrat Musa عليه السلام much trouble, annoyance and distress, both in word and in deed. It was to such an extent that they did not even desist from false accusations and defamation. In the Qur'ān Bani Israel is blamed for the trouble and distress caused to Nabi Musa عليه السلام apart from the incidents that we have mentioned here. In *Surah Ahzab* and *Surah Saf* mention is made of their trouble some nature.

"O you who believe be not like those who vexed and insulted Musa عليه السلام but Allah cleared him of (the calumnies) they had uttered. And he was honourable in Allah's sight." (Ahzab : 69)

Further:

"And remember, Musa عليه السلام said to his people:
O my people why do you vex and insult me,

though you know that I am the apostle of Allah
(sent) to you." (Saf: 5)

In this respect there is the question as to what trouble is referred to here. Does this refer to the rebellious and disobedient of Bani Israel or is there a reference to a specific incident? The correct answer to this question is that as the Qur'ān gave a broad outline account, in concise form, it seems appropriate that we too should not present it as being connected to any specific incident or happening, and to be contented with the concise account.

The Sabbath Day

Hazrat Ibraheem ﷺ fixed one of the seven days of the week as a special day for the worship of Allah. He made it the Friday. During the time of Nabi Musa ﷺ, Bani Israel insisted strongly that on stead of friday, saturday should be that day. As a result of this demand from them Allah revealed to Nabi Musa ﷺ that their request has been granted and saturday has replaced friday. Qur'ān says: "And we told Bani Israel: Transgress not in the matter of the Sabbath And we fork from them a Solemn covenant." (4:154)

Other Matters Concerning Prophethood of Nabi Musa (Alaihis Salām)'s Time

According to the head of the Egyptian Antiquities and historical and archaeological research scholar Ahmad Yusuf Effendi, when Nabi Yusuf ﷺ entered Egypt it was during the 17th dynasty of the Pharaohs and the Fir'own of that time was someone called Ababi I and the Fir'own who caused Bani Israel so much hardships could be Rameses II. He belonged to the 21st dynasty. Nabi Musa ﷺ was born during his rule and was cared for in his palace. Rameses II had this fear that

Bani Israel who had by then grown to hundreds of thousands, may perhaps become inclined to rebellion. For this reason he started causing them injury and calamities. Rameses II in his old age made his son, Merneftah to share the rule of Egypt with him, so it seems possible that Merneftah was the Fir'own who was drowned. Some sort of confirmation for this opinions is found in the fact that according to Egyptian custom there is not a separate grave for Merneftah, but he was buried among the pharaohs of the 18th dynasty.

In the Egyptian Museum there is up to today a corpse of a Pharaoh and according to Muhammad Ahmad Abody in his book '*Dawat-ur-Rasulullah*', the front part of the nose of this corpse is missing. It is possible that the fish of the Red Sea might have eaten it and thereafter in response to Allah's command the corpse was thrown out onto the shore where it was washed up.

"So that you may be a sign for those coming afterwards up to today the mummy (corpse) of Fir'own is saying to spectators: "Look at me with eyes that take a lesson." (10:92)

The Judgement of Maarile Bucaile

The drowning of Fir'own is a story which has been a subject discussed by various scholars, old and new, even now too. Many books have been written, on the subject and are still being written, but almost all of them have dealt with the historical and geographical aspects and in this regard the French writer Maurice Bucaille in his book "*The Bible, the Qur'ān and Science*" has dealt with this subject in considerable detail. Some of them are as follows:

- 1) Nabi Musa ﷺ was born during the rule of Rameses II and was also reared and cared for in his palace.

- 2) Rameses II passed away during the period when Nabi Musa ﷺ was settled in Madyan.
- 3) After the death of Rameses II passed away he was succeeded by his son Marneftah and he was drowned in the Red Sea about 1200 BC. The spot where Bani Israel crossed over the Red Sea cannot be fixed with any certainty.
- 4) The corpses of both Rameses II and Marneftah are preserved in the Egyptian Museum in Cairo.

Rational Views with Regard to the Splitting of the Sea

Then are people who in all issues of *Deen* wish to interpret everything according to materialistic concepts and as such go so far as to denie and reject all miracles which were given to them by Allah in support of their claims to Prophet hood. They are not prepared to concede that any action in this world can be contrary to the World's law of cause and affect. For this reason they take the incident of Nabi Musa (*Alaihis Salām*)'s time, viz the splitting open of the Red Sea and offer various rational explanations for this event.

For example they state as one of their famous explanations for the splitting up of the Red Sea, that it was actually a case of low tide and that it was part of the flux and reflux of the ocean.

However in this explanation they seem to have forgotten that the Bani Israel who crossed over were hundreds of thousands in number according to the Torah. Even if we take that to be an exaggeration then at least there must have been thousands of them. Together with these numbers, were their luggage and possessions and also their

animals and other possessions. Then after that came Fir'own's large army in pursuit of the Israelites. Which drown.

The Qur'ān states:

"So the sea divided and each separate part became like the huge firm mass of a mountain."

(26:64)

It is clear that the above situation remained for such a period until Bani Israel crossed from the one side to the other shore in safety and waited until Fir'own and his army followed them until they were drowned.

The Qur'ān states:

"And we saved Musa عليه السلام and all who were with him. And then we drowned the others. (26:66)

"Verily in this is a Sign"

After this clear explanation it seems that to describe the splitting open of the sea as being a case of flex and reflux of the sea, is a case of denial of the truth.

Sihr (Sorcery) and Religion

1. *Sihr* (Sorcery, Magic) a reality or is it merely deceiving the eyes? With regard to this question it is the opinion of the *Ulama* of the *Ahl-e-Sunnat wa Jama'at* that '*Sihr*' (Sorcery) is a reality and can have harmful effects. Allah in His perfect wisdom has placed these harmful effects in it just as He has places such effect in poisonous substances. But it is not so that *Sihr* is independent of Allah's *Qudrat*, Godforbid! and that it is in itself the causer of those effects. Such a belief is *Kufr*!

2. The *Ulama* have said where in the execution of *Sihr* help is sought from the *Shaitans* or evil souls or beings other than Allah and such beings are called upon to fulfil needs or where in the recitation of *Mantras* their names are mentioned for the purpose of subduing someone, then that act is an act of "*Shirk*" and the doer thereof becomes a *Kaafir*. However if a person uses other means than these and aims to cause others harm, then the perpetrator of such acts is guilty of a great sin-one of the Major sins.

Difference Between a Miracle and Sorcery

The actual miracle of a *Nabi* or a *Rasul* is that teaching of such a *Nabi* which he shows for the guidance of those who are lost or had strayed from the path. This miracle are like a medical prescription and is unique law for the worldly and spiritual success. However it is part of human nature that it demands as a sign of the verification and confirmation of the truth of a claimant that he should show some such form of miraculous actions which the others are unable and incapable of emulating. For this reason it has been Allah's line of action that he always sent some such signs with His Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and Messengers and that when those Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) exhibited those signs with their claim to Prophet hood, such signs which no worldly power could emulate or oppose, such sign were called Miracle or *Mau'jizaah*.

Similarly it has been Allah's line of action that the type of 'sign' which He gave any specific messenger, that 'sign' would be of a similar nature as those things or arts in which that people had some expertise or for which they had become known, and about which they know the intricate details and realities. In this way those people are able to recognise that

this sign of the Prophet ﷺ is something beyond the power and ability of a human being, and if they are not obstinate ones, they would involuntarily exclaim: "This is the act of Allah, the Supreme Being." So the Miracle or *Muajizah* is Allah's act directly which comes to establish the truth of a truthful Prophet and is not based upon laws and principles so that its art can be studied and learnt, and is not such that a *Nabi* will at all times be able to perform it and show it, but comes to be performed mostly when opponents demand and challenge it to be performed. Hence when such a challenge is made to the Prophet ﷺ, then from Allah's side comes the power and ability to perform and show it.

As for Magic or Sorcery, this is a dirty thing with its laws and principles which the sorceror or Magician can apply and practise at any time, even though the reasons for its execution are hidden from the sights of the ordinary man. Those who are acquainted with the dirty Magic are aware of it. Like other arts it is an arranged and compiled one, for which the Egyptians, Chinese and Hindus had become well known.

Then in practical terms which we can see and observe there is one other major difference between *Moujizah* and *Sihr*. As far as the sorceror or Magician is concerned, his life is generally one of causing harm to others, evil doings and as such people fear of him, As for the *Nabi*, his whole life is life of truth, sincerity, sympathy with mankind, fear of God and a life of cleanliness, while his character is unblemished. He does not make the Miracle a way of earning a livelihood but only forth with it to assist in proving his truth or when opponents challenge him to do so. In any case those enemies themselves admit his clean-living habits, although they doubt the truth of his claim to Prophet hood.

Further when there is a confrontation between *Sihr* and *Maujizah* it will always be *Maujizah* who will be victorious and never can *Sihr* ever be victorious.

At the time of Nabi Musa ﷺ, Egypt was almost looked upon as being the capital of the world as far as magic and Sorcery was concerned and the Egyptians had developed it to a fine art amongst themselves.

Life after Death

The Qur'ān has explained life after death in this manner that after the life of this world will follow the life of the hereafter. after death a person will be brought back to life in the here after. This is the general rule. However sometimes for a special reason and for expedience a persons dies and is given life again in this world. In the lives of the Prophets the Qur'ān itself bears testimony to this having happened.

In the life of Nabi Musa ﷺ it so happened that seventy chiefs of Bani Israel were brought back to life. Because of their insulting insistence they were all killed and thereafter a special *Du'a* by Nabi Musa ﷺ they were brought back to life. Similarly in the slaughter of the cow incident, the murdered person was once again brought back to life. In these cases Allah knows best what the expedience (special reason) was. We with our incomplete understanding can only say that the aim was that those who were affected by it should be thankful and not be guilty of similar acts in future and in future become true obedient servants. After having seen the clear evidence from the Qur'ān there is no need to resorts to other interpretations.

The Abundance of Bounties

In spite of the rebellious nature and disobedience of Bani Israel, and from the manner in which the Qur'ān time and again reminds them of Allah's favours on them, the question arises as to why Allah had chosen this nation for showering upon them His bounties. The answer may be this that in that era all the nations of the earth were deeply involved with '*Shirk*' and '*Kufr*', rebellion, disobedience, evil deeds and injustices that if Bani Israel were compared to the others, their evils were less. History provides the evidence that this nation, in spite of its general disobedience, was also responsible for a small group of them used to spread Allah's message of *Hidayat* to the world. In other words Bani Israel being a chosen folk was not because of their own purity or holiness but because through them an end was sought to evil and disobedience.

Musa عليه السلام as a Messenger

In the Holy Qur'ān and the *Hadith* the virtues of Nabi Musa عليه السلام and the incidents of Bani Israel, we come to know the high position of Nabi Musa عليه السلام and his high rank. Moreover if we look at the numerous problems and obstacles he faced in his interaction with Fir'awn, the people of Fir'awn and with Bani Israel, then we come to the conclusion that [(except in the case of Rasulallah ﷺ and Hazrat Ibrheem عليه السلام)] no other *Nabi* had to face such problems. Thus we say that the seal of the Prophets, Sayeduna Muhammad ﷺ and the Mujaddid of the Prophets Hazrat Ibraheem عليه السلام and after them Nabi Musa عليه السلام were the eminent Prophets of especially high rank above all others.

It should also be remembered that according to Baukhary and Muslim Rasulallah ﷺ said:

"Do not consider me superior to Musa ﷺ because on the day of *Qiyamat*, out of fear people will fall down into unconsciousness. The first person to be revived from it will be its consciousness.

Then I will see Musa ﷺ standing holding onto the foot of the throne. I cannot then say whether he regained consciousness before me or whether because of his having fallen into a sworn on Mount Toor, he was today exempted from falling into unconsciousness."

Ibn Katheer states that this statement of Rasulallah ﷺ is one of humility because at another time he is reported to have said: "I am the Sayed among the children of Adam (and I say this) without any boasting." Moreover he is the seal of the Prophets. As for the day of *Qiyamat*, it is possible that it could point to partial superiority of Musa ﷺ in one aspect. That does not affect the general superiority in all other aspects and high rank Rasulallah ﷺ enjoys.

Lessons and Warnings

1. Patience in times of Calamities

If a person is plagued by calamities or miseries, it is best to fare them with patience and contentment. If that is done he can be sure of acquiring much good and he will be successful in reaching his aim.

2. A Condition for success and Victory

The one who in all affairs puts his trust and faith in Allah and with sincerity look upon Him as his supporter, then Allah will ease for him his difficulties and change his calamities into salvation and victory.

3. The Strength of Love for Allah

The person whose affairs with Allah reaches the stage of love for Him, then the greatest power of evil becomes like nothing in front of him.

4. Divine Help

If any of Allah's servants, fighting in the way of truth stands steadfastly against evil, Allah creates helpers for him from among the enemies and the supporters of evil.

5. The Effect of Ecstasy of Imān

If a person once has fasted the ecstasy of true faith and with this whole heart has accepted it, then this intoxication is of such a nature that from every hair on his body the truth is exclaimed.

6. The Fruits of Patience

The Fruits of patience are always sweet, no matter how much bitterness is experienced in acquiring it. Whenever it is acquired it will be sweet.

7. The Results of Slavery

The biggest effect of a life of bondage and slavery is that one is devoid of any courage, and one begins to accept the humiliating life of bondage as a bounty. and looks upon the inferior position of safety as being something great. And one begins to look upon any life of striving for better things as being trouble some.

8. Conditions for Inheriting the Land

To inherit the land on a country is for those people who without any fear and with courage and bravery is prepared to

face and over come all difficulties and obstacles, depending on Allah and relying on Him is prepared to enter into the field of striving and battle.

9. The Defeat of Baatil (evil)

No matter how great the powers of evil are and no matter how much pomp and splendour they enjoy, the end result will always be that they will be unsuccessful in their endeavours and success and victory will be for those who are righteous and pious.

10. The Result of Unjust, Evil-doing Nations

It is Allah's Sunnat and line of action that all tyrannical and unjust nations who subjugate and persecute and humiliate other weaker nations, a day surely comes when those weak ones become inheritors of the land and bring an end to the rule of those unjust rulers.

11. The End Result of those Intoxicated with Power

The groups of people or nations who are filled with their intoxication of power, government and wealth have always been prepared to wage battle against the invitation and call towards truth, but the history of nations also informs us that such groups have always been defeated in the end and have had to stare failure in the face.

12. The End Result of Rebellion

The person or group of people who recognise the truth and still reject Allah's signs with acts of disobedience, for them Allah's law is this that he destroys within them the ability to accept truth because that is the necessary result of rebellion against Allah.

13. Stead Fastness in Deen

Whether anyone accepts the word of truth or not, it remains the duty of the one conveying the truth to continue to call to it and never to stop.

14. Punishment not Reward

When a tyrannical and oppressive leader becomes a ruler of people, this is definitely not a sign of that ruler being acceptable in the sight of Allah. It is actually a punishment over that people for their evil deeds, but when the people over whom he rules becomes so impressed in their minds with the tyrants rule, it after happens that they begin to look upon that rule as being Allah's Mercy.

15. Allah's Tolerance and Patience

When a nation or any group of people becomes involved with evil acts and rebellion and disobedience, it is Allah's law that He does not immediately seize them for His punishment, but gives them respite for a time that may be they will desist from such acts. Perhaps they will understand and change their ways. But when they do not incline towards repairing and rectifying their actions, and their rebellion and disobedience reaches a specific limit, then He seizes them and destroy them.

16. The Nature of Man's Knowledge

It is not fitting for any person on earth, even if he be a Prophet or a Rasul, to make this claim that in this world there is no greater person in knowledge than him. He should rather refer it to Allah's knowledge.

17. Slavery is a Curse

For the followers of the Religion of Islam slavery is a great curse, which is sign of Allah's anger and wrath. To be

contented with it is synonymous to be contented with punishment from Allah and with Allah's curses.

Important Points

The Position of Divine Revelation

The statements of the Holy Qur'ān are a real test for those followers of European thought, especially those who are quick to accept every point of research of the Orientalists with out any questions and are prepared to believe truly in the 'truth' of their researches, and for those who at all times finds doubts in the Qur'ān, who consider their theories and explanations as being more acceptable than the Qur'ān, which is Divine Revelation. Yet they should also bear in mind that these European Researchers and scholars very often discard their previously held views to accept new ones. One should also bear in mind that the path of faith and *Yaqeen* which had been established by Divine Revelation i.e., the Qur'ān has not once been found to be necessary to change its position at all.

The Effects of Continuous Slavery and Bondage

It is an accepted fact of history that when a nation has been in a state of bondage for centuries, then their bad state does not merely end here where their bad position, poverty, miserable condition becomes visible. In fact more worse than their practical weakness is their mental weakness and lack of courage. They lose all courage and bravery. They become contented with their weakness and have a hopeless-ness in their make-up and they consider humiliation as an indication of patience. Therefore when a Messenger of Allah calls them

to pull them out of this mental weakness and encourage them towards courage and bravery, this seems to them to be a very difficult or even impossible task. Sometimes they are frightened by the difficulties and begin to fight among themselves and sometimes they begin to cast doubts on the Messenger who guides them. Should any obstacle arise along the way they even put the blame on their Nabi or leader accusing him of being the cause of their misfortunes.

The Blessings of Imān

In the sight of Allah criterion for honour lies in truth and sincerity and in faithfulness in being a bondsman of His. It does not lie in worldly wealth and riches or in pomp and splendour. However the person who attains honour in His sight, He also grants him all these things.

ADDITION BY THE ARRANGER OF THIS VOLUME

The Imān of a Baedwi

In the National Geographic Magazine of January 1976 a journalistic survey by Harvey Arden appears under the title "In search of Moses;" is printed. In this account of the circumstances Harvey Arden explained how he followed the path taken by the Israelites according to the Biblical records. He followed the northern and southern routes which Nabi Musa ﷺ took out of Egypt over the Red Sea and where Fir'awn was drowned. Arden also produced a map giving all the places where Nabi Musa ﷺ passes. However there was a bit of doubt as to which specific route Nabi Musa ﷺ took. This is not surprising.

In the end he wrote: "That for which he searched, he did find but he imagines with more certainty that in that land after such a search and investigation he became convinced of the presence of "Allah, the one without any associate" whose glory Musa ﷺ had perceived when in this sacred surroundings he went to fetch some fire. Praise be to Allah, he found the simple understanding of Allah's presence from a Bedouin herdsman as can be seen from the following conversation:

Arden: Are you the owner of this land?

Muslim Baedwi: "The earth belongs to Allah."

Arden: "And this tree."

Muslim Baedwi: "This tree also belongs to Allah."

(Then he said after a thought): This olive tree is mine."

(The answer of the Baedwi reminds us of the answer which Nabi Musa ﷺ gave in a speech to his people:)

"Musa ﷺ said: O people seek Allah's help and have patience verily the earth belongs to Allah. He grants it to whomsoever of His servants He wishes."
(*Al-A'raaf*)

Towards the end of his survey Arden quotes another faith Kindling incident:

"Looking towards the outside I saw a young Arab herdsman who was herding his sheep in this valley; which had been filled with water through the staff of Nabi Musa ﷺ. This young man put down his stick and climbed onto one side of the mountain and there began to pray his *Salaah* of *Maghrib*, bending his head and

prostrating before Allah at such a time when the red glow at sunset was quite visible seeing this scene affected me in unexplainable terms. No other scene can be more impressive than this. At this stage my search for Musa ﷺ was terminated and a new life began."

The Greatness of the Sahaba

When we ponder over the behaviours of Bani Israel, we feel a special appreciation for the greatness and righteousness of the *Sahabah*. On the one side were the continuous bounties from Allah on Bani Israel and from their side the continuous rejection and disobedience and rebellion. Compare that with the strength of *Imān*, their truthfulness and purity, their patience in spite of numerous obstacles and their exceptional love for Rasulallah ﷺ. You cannot but be impressed by those things. Not one incident can be told where in the face of obstacles any of the *Sahabah* cut off their relationship with *Imān*. Not only that it is even hard to find anyone mentioning a word of complaint.

QASASUL AMBIYAA

STORIES OF THE PROPHETS

Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy (Rah.)



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Qasasul Ambiyaa

(Stories of the Prophets)

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Qasasul Ambiyaa

The Holy Qur'ān does not relate historical facts merely for the sake of telling a story which is of historical value. Its main aim in relating happenings is to draw attention to the results, conclusions and deductions from these incidents so that they become a source of guidance for men and prove to be lessons for them that appeal to their minds and emotions that from these historical events, lessons should be derived. These lessons should convince them that the existence of Allah is an undeniable fact and that His Mighty Hand is playing a major role in the affairs of men. It should also bring to their notice that to follow the stipulations of His deen brings success and leads to salvation and is the way towards all progress. That is what Islām—the natural religion—is about.

From: Qasasul Qur'ān

Preface

The most authentic and comprehensive work of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy, *Qasasul Qur'ān* needs no introduction. However, the Manner in which our friend Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version of a voluminous and bulky work he has undoubtedly, fulfilled one of the needs of this time. He has adopted such a method of abridgement whereby not only has he retained and mentioned every important fact in the lives of the Holy Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and other saintly personalities, which are of lessons to men, but also discussed in brought outline some other important matters. It is hoped that with Allah's grace, those persons who are occupied and busy at all times, will be able to derive adequate benefit from this work.

The great effort of Sayed Tanzeem Hussain in this old age of his is really something praiseworthy. May Allah reward him well for this great effort.

Qari Sayed Rasheedul-Hasan Hussainy Nadwi

Imam and Khateeb

Jama Masjid, New Town

Allamah Binori Town, Karachi

P5 Muharram, 1308 Hijri

Publisher's Foreword

The respected personality of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy is one of the most eminent Ulama of the Indo-Pak Sub-Continent. His most approved and well-known book, *Qasasul-Qur'ān* is considered to be a unique publication on this subject. The point that distinguishes it from other similar books is the fact that after every story, Maulana has made use of deep thought and reflection to present to the readers the lessons and points of guidance from the related episodes. Thus for the teachers and lecturers at *Deeni Madressas* and for preachers in mosques and students of deen the study and perusal of this book is of utmost benefit.

The original book appeared in four volumes with over 1800 pages of subject matter. Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version there of in only 600 pages and this has been met with a verdict of approval from all academic circles, especially by virtue of the fact that he has fulfilled one of the most pressing needs of the time and by leaving aside unimportant discussions have given the busy and occupied ones also a chance to benefit from these work. May Allah reward him well.

Author's Foreword

All praise be to Allah who has guided us with the Holy Book and revealed to us the Qur'ān in a clear Arabic language and in it. He related the best of stories as an admonition and a reminder for the believers. And May peace and blessings be upon the Most truthful and trustworthy Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, the messenger of Allah and seal of all the Prophets and upon his offspring, and companions who were all of them guiding stars for all the righteous ones.

Among the inimitable ways in which Allah has chosen for the sake of the guidance of men, is this that attention is drawn to the good and bad deeds of nations and the resultant fruits of such deeds of which they are reminded so that those deeds may be a lesson for men. For this reason those stories are not being related in a style as is generally done in history. The major aim is to convey the truth and to invite to Allah and with this in mind attention is only drawn to those aspects which furthers this objective. For this reason there is constant repetition so that these events can sink into the hearts and minds of listeners and they become attentive towards them. This sinking in and attentiveness can only be achieved if the same event is repeated in various ways and styles whereby sleeping faculties are woken up.

The Qur'ānic stories and events deal mostly with previous nations and the Messengers of Allah (*Alaihimus*

Salām) who were sent to them and bit by bit other matters also become included there-in, mostly dealing with the arguments over good and bad and the battles between the friends of Allah and the friends of *Shaitan*, which in itself proves to be a great lesson and admonishment for me.

But, leaving others aside, there are today so few Muslims who derive benefit from Allah's last and perfect law-book, the Qur'ān, to fill our hearts with *Iman* and *Yaqeen*. After all it is Allah's law and we are commanded to implement its orders in our lives, Moreover we are required to ponder over its meanings as this Qur'ān is the means forwards acquiring success and salvation in both this world and the here after.

At the time of the Revelation of the Qur'ān, the Messenger of Allah became so distressed and defected at the enmity and opposition of the polytheists that he raised this complaint to Allah:

(5:25—30)

However, in this 15th century, if we should examine our hearts, we will find that in spite of our claims to be Muslims and believing the Qur'ān to be the word of Allah, how few are who have made this word of Allah the pattern for their lives and the model on which to base their lives, who read and recited with this aim in mind?

It was my aim, seeing this condition of my people and myself, to translate this great source of admonition into Urdu so that by presenting the translated version, the hearts of people will automatically become drawn to the original i.e., the Qur'ān and thereby acquire everlasting happiness.

In spite of my simple style of writing, care has been taken to confine myself to a few special points.

- (a) In this book the basis for all the stories is the Holy Qur'ān and the authentic *Hadith* and these have been further elucidated with historical facts.
- (b) Where there appears any contradiction or differences in the stories as told in the old testament and the Qur'ān, then with clear arguments an effort has been made either to reconcile the versions or with clear arguments to prove the truth as is expounded in the Qur'ān.
- (c) An effort has been made to point out the nonsensical Israili stories and where there have been nonsensical objections from enemies, these have in the light of the true facts been made clear for what they are.
- (d) In some special places there have been introduced some discussions on matters of disputes in *Tafseer* and *Hadith* and after discussing these the views of the saintly elders have been mentioned as a solution.
- (e) The facts concerning every Prophet ﷺ and in which chapter of the Qur'ān they are mentioned, has been gathered in one place.
- (f) Lastly, together with all the above points, a special heading of "Results and lessons", is introduced, giving the actual objective of this book and its main purpose viz., admonition and warning. Special attention is drawn to this aspect.

Servant of the Millat

Muhammad Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy

22 Rajab, 1360 Hijri

Translator's Foreword

For me as the translator of this book by Maulana Hifzur Rahman is a great honour. Throughout my student days in Darul Uloom Deoband in India, Maulana Hifzur Rahman or as we know him then as the *Mujahid-e-Millat* was one of the most respected leaders of the Muslim community. We used to flock to listen to his most interesting lectures. And as the general secretary of the *Jamiatul-Ulama*, and a M.P. he was also a great 'Alim (scholar) as can be gauged from this book *Qasasul Ambiya* (Tales of the Prophets) which entailed great research. I can remember whenever the students were confronted with any problem in the lives of any of the prophets, they always took refuge in Maulana's book for answers. I took upon it as a great honour in being in some small manner associated with Maulana's scholarship, even though this is an abridged version of the original book. But I must also state that I found great difficulty in translating this book because of the exceptionally high quality of the Urdu language used in the book.

I hope that the English translation of Maulana Hifzur Rahman's scholarly work will also be of great benefit to the English-speaking people. I just hope that I have been able to do justice to the original thoughts of the author.

Yusuf Karaan
Strand, South Africa